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The Complete Queen's Indian Defense

e4 restraint, fianchetto systems, central breaks, and transpositions

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

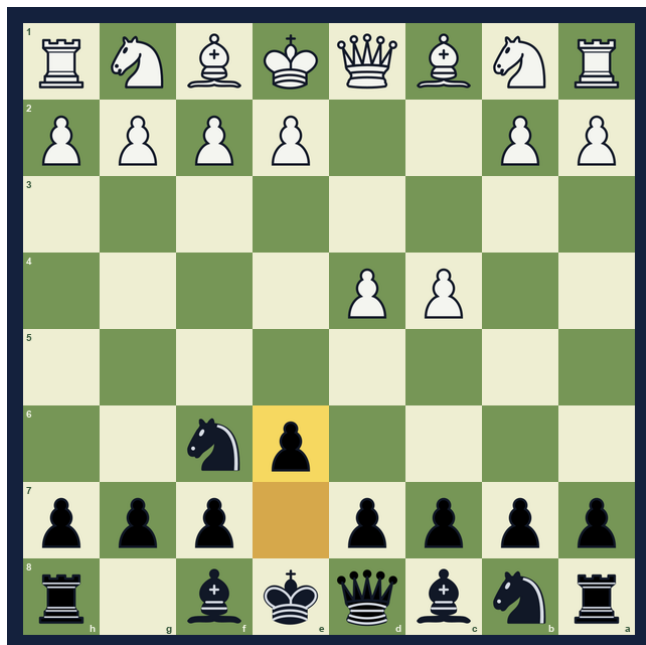
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
01 - Foundation	2
02 - Fianchetto	6
03 - Classical	4
04 - Petrosian	2
05 - Solid Systems	4
06 - Transpositions	2

01. Queen's Indian Core - Move Order



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Queen's Indian Core structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses g3, Nc3, or a3 to gain space and the bishop pair.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian Core.

01. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian Core - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian Core.

02. Queen's Indian Core



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Black controls e4 with pieces and prepares a queenside fianchetto.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop the bishop according to White's setup and challenge the center with ...d5 or ...c5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses g3, Nc3, or a3 to gain space and the bishop pair.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

The Queen's Indian restrains e4 first and chooses the pawn break second.

02. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian Core

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Queen's Indian restrains e4 first and chooses the pawn break second.

03. Fianchetto with ...Ba6 - Move Order



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Fianchetto with ...Ba6 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White completes the fianchetto and seeks e4 or d5 space.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Fianchetto with ...Ba6.

03. Decision Framework

Fianchetto with ...Ba6 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Fianchetto with ...Ba6.

04. Fianchetto with ...Ba6



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Black develops outside the pawn chain and provokes queenside concessions.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the bishop to pressure c4 and complete development before choosing ...d5 or ...c5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White completes the fianchetto and seeks e4 or d5 space.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7 7. Bg2 O-O 8. O-O

MEMORY RULE

The ...Ba6 system is useful when it changes White's queenside development.

04. Decision Framework

Fianchetto with ...Ba6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The ...Ba6 system is useful when it changes White's queenside development.

05. Classical 4.Nc3 - Move Order



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Classical 4.Nc3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses d5 and e4 to restrict Black.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Nc3.

05. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Nc3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

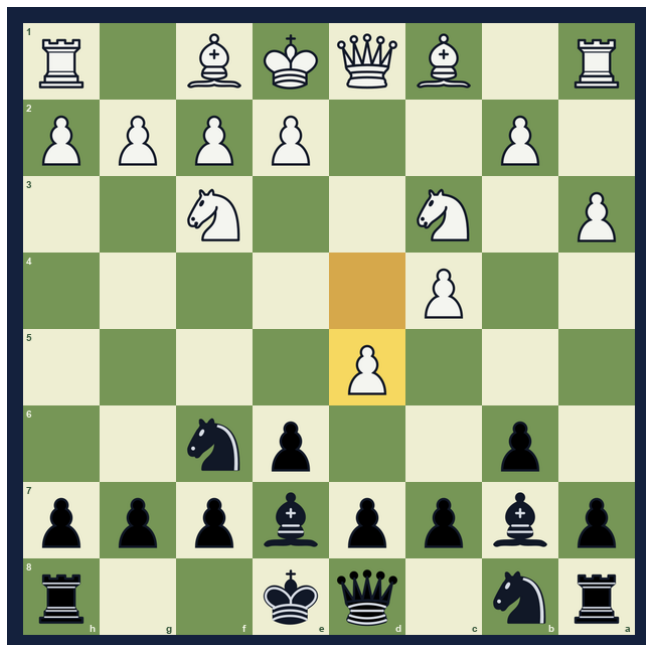
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Nc3.

06. Classical 4.Nc3



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

White gains central space while Black's bishop pressures the long diagonal.

PRIMARY PLAN

Attack the center with ...exd5 or ...c5 and avoid passive piece placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses d5 and e4 to restrict Black.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. Nc3 Bb7 5. a3 Be7 6. d5

MEMORY RULE

A space advantage must be challenged before it fixes every piece's role.

06. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Nc3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A space advantage must be challenged before it fixes every piece's role.

07. Petrosian 4.a3 - Move Order



04 - Petrosian

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Petrosian 4.a3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and may use the Carlsbad structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Petrosian 4.a3.

07. Decision Framework

Petrosian 4.a3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

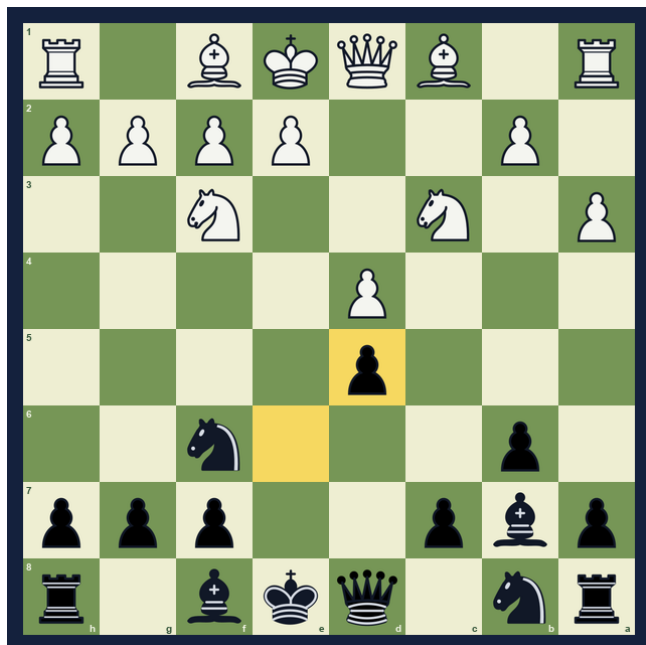
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Petrosian 4.a3.

08. Petrosian 4.a3



04 - Petrosian

READ THE POSITION

White prevents ...Bb4 and prepares a broad center without doubled-pawn concerns.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use central activity and piece pressure because the bishop check is unavailable.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and may use the Carlsbad structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. a3 Bb7 5. Nc3 d5 6. cxd5 exd5

MEMORY RULE

When a3 removes one plan, redirect immediately toward the center.

08. Decision Framework

Petrosian 4.a3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When a3 removes one plan, redirect immediately toward the center.

09. Queen's Indian 4.e3 - Move Order



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Queen's Indian 4.e3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses b3, Bb2, and e4 for a broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian 4.e3.

09. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian 4.e3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian 4.e3.

10. Queen's Indian 4.e3



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

White develops quietly while preserving central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development and choose ...d5 or ...c5 before White gains e4 comfortably.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses b3, Bb2, and e4 for a broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. e3 Bb7 5. Bd3 Be7 6. O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

Quiet development still contains a clock: challenge e4 before it arrives for free.

10. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian 4.e3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Quiet development still contains a clock: challenge e4 before it arrives for free.

11. ...Ba6 and ...Qe7 - Move Order



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Reach the ...Ba6 and ...Qe7 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may gain tempi with a3 and seek central expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward ...Ba6 and ...Qe7.

11. Decision Framework

...Ba6 and ...Qe7 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

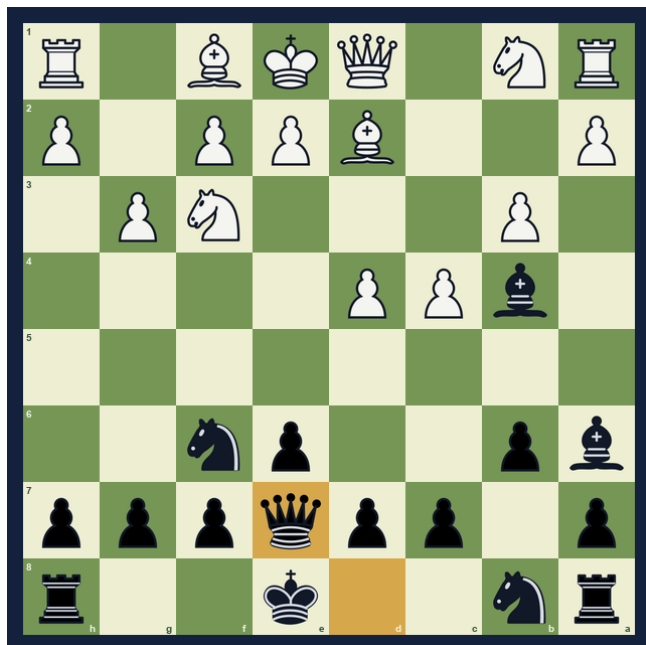
ACTIVE RECALL

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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward ...Ba6 and ...Qe7.

12. ...Ba6 and ...Qe7



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Black uses the queen to support the bishop and pressure c4.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development without exposing the queen and decide whether to exchange on d2.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may gain tempi with a3 and seek central expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Qe7

MEMORY RULE

Piece pressure works only when the queen does not become a target.

12. Decision Framework

...Ba6 and ...Qe7

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Piece pressure works only when the queen does not become a target.

13. Long-Diagonal Pressure - Move Order



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Long-Diagonal Pressure structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White keeps the bishop pair and may build e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Long-Diagonal Pressure.

13. Decision Framework

Long-Diagonal Pressure - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Long-Diagonal Pressure.

14. Long-Diagonal Pressure



02 - Fianchetto

READ THE POSITION

Black exchanges the c3-knight and reduces White's central control.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the long diagonal and central break to justify the exchange.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White keeps the bishop pair and may build e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. Nc3 Ne4 8. Qc2 Nxc3 9. Qxc3

MEMORY RULE

Exchange a knight only when the resulting diagonal or structure improves.

14. Decision Framework

Long-Diagonal Pressure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Exchange a knight only when the resulting diagonal or structure improves.

15. Queen's Indian d5 Space - Move Order



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Queen's Indian d5 Space structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White supports the space and may use e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian d5 Space.

15. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian d5 Space - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Queen's Indian d5 Space.

16. Queen's Indian d5 Space



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

White gains space while Black pins the knight and attacks the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the pin to undermine e4 and challenge d5 with ...exd5 or ...c6.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White supports the space and may use e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. Nc3 Bb7 5. d5 Bb4

MEMORY RULE

A pin is valuable when it increases pressure on the center, not by itself.

16. Decision Framework

Queen's Indian d5 Space

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A pin is valuable when it increases pressure on the center, not by itself.

17. Quiet Fianchetto - Move Order



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Quiet Fianchetto structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses d5, Nc3, or Re1-e4 plans according to the break.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Quiet Fianchetto.

17. Decision Framework

Quiet Fianchetto - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Quiet Fianchetto.

18. Quiet Fianchetto



05 - Solid Systems

READ THE POSITION

Both sides complete development before defining the central structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Watch e4, prepare ...d5 or ...c5, and keep the queen's knight flexible.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses d5, Nc3, or Re1-e4 plans according to the break.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

In quiet positions, the first central transformation defines the middlegame.

18. Decision Framework

Quiet Fianchetto

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In quiet positions, the first central transformation defines the middlegame.

19. English Move Order - Move Order



06 - Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

Reach the English Move Order structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may avoid Nc3 and keep flexible English options.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nf3 e6 3. g3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Move Order.

19. Decision Framework

English Move Order - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward English Move Order.

20. English Move Order



06 - Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

The Queen's Indian arises through an English move order.

PRIMARY PLAN

Recognize the structure and preserve the same e4-control and break logic.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may avoid Nc3 and keep flexible English options.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nf3 e6 3. g3 b6 4. Bg2 Bb7 5. O-O Be7 6. d4 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Move orders change available tactics, not the structure's central questions.

20. Decision Framework

English Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move orders change available tactics, not the structure's central questions.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.